

Rajiv Gandhi College of Engineering and Technology

Pondicherry

Department of First Year Engineering

Communicative English Question Bank with Answers

Unit – II

2 Mark Questions

1. What is Scanning in reading comprehension? (Nov16, April 17, Nov 18)

Scanning the text before reading provides the reader with some key information about the text that will make reading faster and more effective. Scanning techniques are useful to discover graphic information, look for any references or biography listings, and look for any notes or questions or remarks at the end of the text. Identifying non-verbal signs and other aids in reading the text makes reading easier.

2. What is Skimming? (April 17, Jan 15)

Skimming a technical text before detailed reading provides better comprehension and ensures a high degree of remembrance. The reader should take a few minutes to skim the text before detailed reading in order to understand its gist. The reader should discover the purpose and organization of the text, understand the subject of the text, and authors's central idea or point of view about the subject. He/she should be able to identify the main points of the text.

3. What will be the role and importance of note - making?

Note – Making is an important study skill that is requires for various academic and professional purposes. It involves a careful reading plan, note writing techniques, reduction devices, organization techniques and methods of sequencing. Making notes help us to retain all the information. Identifying key points and comprehending the content is important in note making.

4. What are the various skills for reading?

Reading skills include vocabulary skills, visual perceptual skills, prediction technique, and scanning, skimming and intensive reading skills. We need to learn and polish these reading skills in order to become efficient and active readers.

Vocabulary skills involve word meaning, recognition and guessing the meaning of unknown words from word structure and context. Visual perceptual skills involve effective eye reading requires accurate visual perception of words and phrases, faster eye fixation and complete elimination of vocalization.

Prediction technique involves the use of index, heading, sub-headings, non verbal context and linguistic clues to guess the information that a text contains.

5. What are the steps involved in reading a passage?

The process involved while reading a passage are:

Skimming: To read something quickly and understanding the main points of the passage.

Scanning: To look through a text in order to locate a specific part of it.

Studying: To read and examine carefully.

Guessing: An attempt to find answer to a question to which one does not know the correct or exact answer.

Inferring: To form an opinion based on something that one has come to know.

6. What is contextual meaning?

The meaning of a word will be determined according to the context in which is used. The reader needs to look for the contextual signal words that indirectly help to define an unknown word or phrase. Thus the reader can guess the meaning of an unknown or unfamiliar word by analyzing its structure or analyzing the contextual clues.

7. Write a short note on Active and Passive reading.

Reading is not merely a passive process of absorbing the message encoded into the printed word, but a dynamic communicative process in which the reader approaches the text for a particular reason. One needs to be an active reader rather than a passive one.

Active Reading	Passive reading
The reader pays attention to both content as well as style.	The reader pays attention to either content or style.
The reader pays attention to the writer's intention.	The reader does not pay attention to the writer's intention
The reader predicts and responds to context.	The reader does not predict and respond to context.

8. Write a note on index.

Index is a list of topics and their sub topics which are discussed in a particular book or journal arranged in an alphabetical order for easy and quick reference. It is usually at the back of a book or a journal.

It differs from contents as, contents lists the topics by grouping them according to the chapter which they come under. But index lists them in alphabetical order.

9. Define intensive reading.

Intensive reading is a detailed reading that demands better concentration and motivation. The three rapid reading techniques of production scanning and skimming prepare the reader for intensive reading.

10. Write any few Homophone words in your own idea.

Beer – bier

Berry – bury

Bight – bite

Caught – court

Censer – censor.

11. What is Topicalization in reading comprehension?

After reading a passage carefully and identifying the central idea, main points, and important supporting details should be rephrased. While rephrasing a section of a text or sentence, unnecessary or redundant words/ phrases should be removed.

12. Write the uses of Abbreviation and give few examples.

There are standard abbreviations used in science and technologies, moreover you may abbreviate words and phrases by using the following simple methods.

Word abbreviations:

Sulphur – S

Kilogram – Kg

Magnesium – Mg

Compare – cf

Use of symbols:

@ - at the rate of

% - percentage

13. Write the comprehension of Technical and Non – Technical materials. (April 17, May19)

Reading technical text is entirely different from reading general material. In order to ensure a high degree of understanding and remembrance, the reader should flow on the subject to concentrate better. Moreover the reader should recall related information that he/she already knows. This pre-reading stage may not take more time and is helpful in preparing the reader for detailed reading.

5 or 6 Mark Questions

1. Illustrate the **Scanning in detail. (Jan16)**

Scanning refers to the ability to locate specific information or facts as quick as possible. Scanning the text before reading provides the reader with some key information about the text that will make reading faster and effective. Scanning techniques are useful to discover graphic information. Identifying non-verbal signs and other aids in the reading text makes reading easier.

While trying to look for the meaning of the word in a dictionary or looking for a telephone number in the telephone directory, we scan and try to look for specific information. Scanning is an important rapid reading technique, which provides better comprehension while reading a scientific or technical text. It includes locating

- Specific point in a text
- A word in a dictionary
- A formula in a text
- Train or television schedules
- Examination results
- Any notes/ questions, remarks at the end of text.

To increase the scanning speed with accuracy everyone have to keep the following in the mind.

- ❖ Know what you want to find.
- ❖ Do not read everything
- ❖ Use guides and aids
- ❖ Know the organization of the material to be read
- ❖ Concentrate while scanning.

2. Define **Skimming in detailed manner. (Nov 19)**

The main objective of skimming is to understand the central idea and the main points of a text; the reader needs to use reading strategy that involves discovering the purpose and organization of the text. One of the most important purposes for reading academic and professional purposes is to obtain relevant information. Skimming is essential for better understanding of a text.

Identifying central idea:

The first step of skimming is to identify the central idea. Every essay, article, passage or textbook chapter deals with central idea. All the other ideas, examples, illustrations in the text, support and expand this central idea.

Recognizing main idea:

Once the central idea of the text has been identified, the reader can easily recognize the main ideas that support and expand the central idea. In order to do

this, the reader first needs to identify the topic sentence in each paragraph of the text. I.e, each paragraph may deal with one main idea.

Identifying writing pattern:

Skimming involves discovering the purpose and organization of a text. While skimming a text the reader should be able to identify the specific writing pattern used by the writer in the passage. Technical writers use different writing patterns to develop ideas. A writer usually writes according to the nature and the types of message to be communicated.

- Definition
- Description
- Sequence of events
- Classifications
- Illustrations
- Cause and effects.

3. What are the steps involved in Note-Making? (April 19)

The amount of information available to us is so much that you cannot collect and retain everything. Hence making notes help us to retain all the information.

Steps involved in note making:

- Read the passage.
- Understand the content.
- Identify the underlying key words and sentences.
- Copy them down. You can use your own abbreviations.
- Group these essential expressions according to the sequences in which they appear in the passage.
- Give suitable titles to the notes and subtitles to the paragraph.
- If necessary, you can copy meaningful quotations from the passage for your later use.
- If you think the information is important you can write down the title of the passage (page no,) the author, the publisher and the years of publication.
- As a first step compare your notes with the passage for content accuracy.

Five steps involved in reading a passage which is essential in a note making process are:

- ❖ Skimming: reading quickly noting only the important points.
- ❖ Scanning: looking quickly in order to identify the relevant information.

- ❖ Studying devote time and attention to read widely and deeply to gather information.
- ❖ Guessing: trying to arrive at answers.
- ❖ Inferring: finally coming to a conclusion about the given passage.

Straight 11 Mark Question

UNIT - II

13 Read the following passages.

The sun is the most direct source of energy. It powers the flow of wind and water cycles and sustains all life. Plants use this energy to synthesize carbohydrates from simple substances like carbon dioxide and water. All the food is derived from the process of photosynthesis. In fact, the energy by which all the animals including human beings live is generated by the oxidation of the food produced by the plants.

The sun contains in its core hydrogen nuclei moving at very great speeds. Whenever these nuclei collide and fuse to form a nucleus of a heavier element, it results in nuclear reactions. These reactions generate tremendous amount of energy. It is energy that powers the sun.

The sun emits lights of different wave lengths. If sun light is passed through a prism, each of these wavelengths is refracted by a different amount. Violet has the shortest wavelength, and red has the longest. The wavelength of the green is midway between that of violet and red. Light with wavelength shorter than that of violet is called the ultraviolet light. Light with wavelength longer than that of red light is called infrared light about one third of light from sun is infrared.

We know that nuclear reactions that go on in the interior of the sun liberate a large amount of energy. Nuclear of deuterium, which is the heavier isotope of hydrogen collide in the suns interior to produce helium. The energy liberated in these reaction fires the sun, which, in turn, emits lights of different wavelength. Of these wavelengths that heat up the earth. The reaction in which the hydrogen in the sun is converted into helium is called the fusion reaction.

- (a) Make the detailed notes of the above passage.

(5)

- (b) Summarize the passage to about 1/3 of its length.

(6)

(Or)

14. (a) Answer the questions: (6x1=6) (6)

- I. What is fusion reaction?
- II. What is nuclear reaction?

- III. What is the central idea of the passage?
- IV. What is photosynthesis?
- V. What is refraction?
- VI. What is infrared light?

(b) State whether the following are *True* or *False*: (5x1=5) (5)

- I. Sun powers the flow of wind and water cycles and sustains all life.
- II. Human die of oxidation of the food produced by plants.
- III. The sun emits lights of same wavelength.
- IV. Nuclear reaction that goes in the interior of the sun liberates a large amount of energy.
- V. The fusion reaction converts helium to hydrogen.

Note: Most of the questions in the Part B of second unit may ask generally with comprehension analysis pattern. Students are instructed to refer the model question in the book back part.